

NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF DESIGN · RECRUITER PORTAL REDESIGN

The recruiter journey NID never *wrote* *down.*

A migration-grade rebuild of the Industry Interface placement portal. **Reverse-engineered from the institute's real internal structures**, brand-true to nid.edu, and modular enough to swap into the live system one surface at a time.



01

THE CORE PROBLEM

The visible portal is the small part.

Industry Interface runs on ASP.NET Web Forms, with cycle dates hand-edited into the HTML and onboarding that still begins as an email. The workflow underneath, from first contact to a signed offer, carries caveats that never surface until a recruiter is already mid-cycle.

01 An undocumented workflow

Onboarding, selection, and offers run on conventions the placement cell holds in its head, not in the system. New recruiters keep hitting rules they could not see.

03 Portfolios that will not load

The portfolio surface ships roughly 8 MB per discipline view, fetched one student at a time, so recruiters often cannot find a portfolio that is sitting right there.

02 A missing compliance spine

Stipend floors, GST-correct receipts, data residency, an audit trail: government and institutional norms live in email threads and scanned PDFs, not in the product.

04 Fragmented contact

Two mailboxes, scattered phone numbers, no single status surface. "Did anyone read my email" becomes the recruiter's default state for weeks.

The thesis. Fix the workflow, not just the screens. Surface the hidden caveats, encode the compliance, and make the portfolio findable, without forcing the institute into a risky big-bang cutover.

02

HOW I WORKED WITH AI

AI did the reading. I held the judgment.

AI synthesised the public research, drafted the architecture, and wrote first-pass code across four build rounds. **I decided what to build, what to refuse, and where a cheaper tool beats a clever one.** The interesting calls were mine; the volume was the model's.

● Decisions I made

- **AI translates, never judges**
The system maps recruiter vocabulary to NID disciplines and summarises long JDs. It never ranks, scores, or filters students. The line is drawn in the product, not just the prompt.
- **ML over LLM where the task is structured**
JD extraction, skill matching, scope-creep checks, stipend math: deterministic ML and pure formulas. The system stays light, fast, cheap, and self-hostable.

● How the build stayed coherent

- **A context contract per module**
Every module carries a five-file markdown contract plus a git-backed memory layer, so any model could resume the build without re-reading the whole history.
- **A human gate on every merge**
Adversarial verification, strict TypeScript, and module-boundary checks. The model proposes; the gates and I dispose.

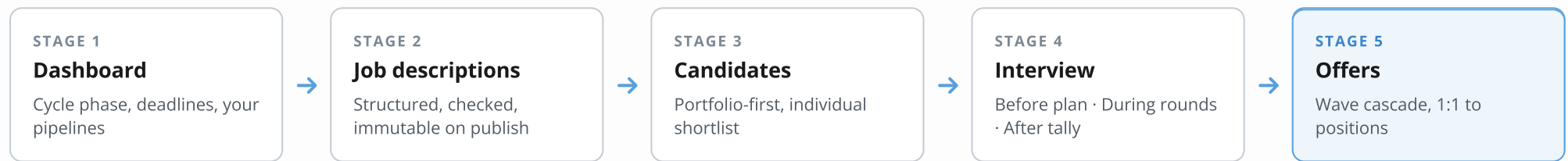
Why it reads as built, not generated. The choices that shape this portal are refusals: no fit-score, no bulk shortlist, no LLM where a formula will do. A first-draft copy-paste would have added features; the work was in taking them away.

THE SOLUTION · INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

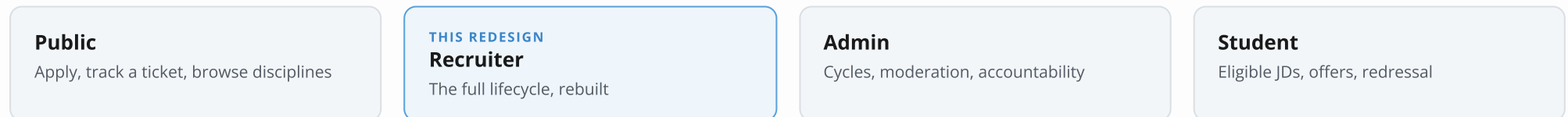
One forward-only pipeline, four modular surfaces.

The recruiter side becomes a strict left-to-right pipeline. Lock a stage and the previous one turns read-only, so the workflow can never quietly run backwards.

THE RECRUITER PIPELINE



FOUR SURFACES, EACH A SWAPPABLE MODULE



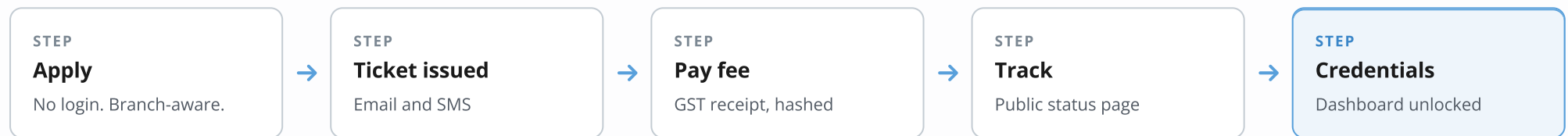
Migration-grade by design. Only the recruiter surface is rebuilt, in a way that does not break the existing workflow. Each surface sits behind a stable interface, so the institute's engineers can chain the new portal in beside the old one and retire it cycle by cycle, integrated systems intact.

THE SOLUTION · PROCESS MAP

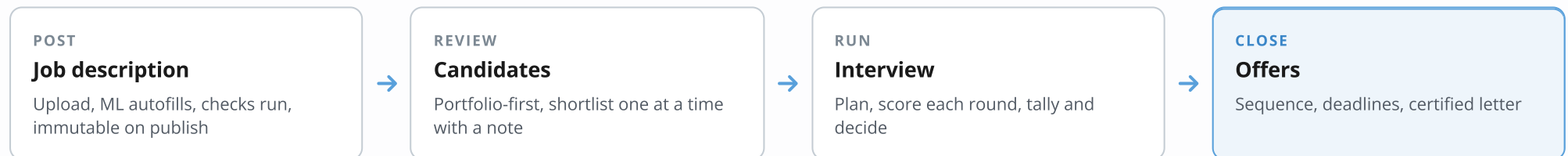
From first contact to a signed offer.

The whole journey, with the caveats now built in as guardrails rather than tribal knowledge.

BEFORE LOGIN · THE PUBLIC TRACK



INSIDE THE PORTAL · THE CYCLE



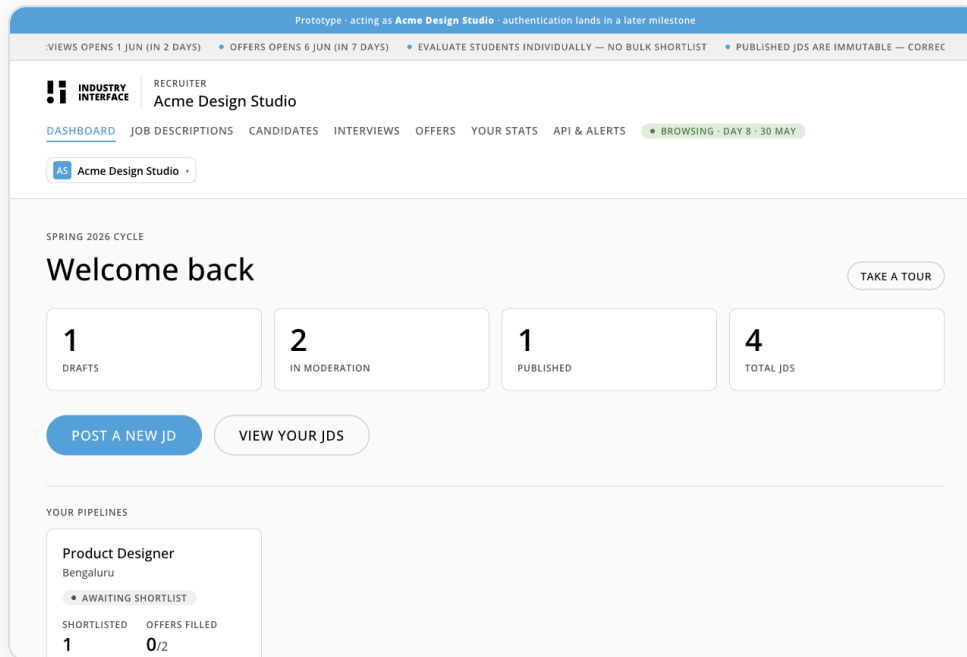
* no bulk shortlist

* no fit-score

stipend floor checked **both ends**JDs **immutable** after publishoffers never exceed **open positions**every mutation **audit-logged**

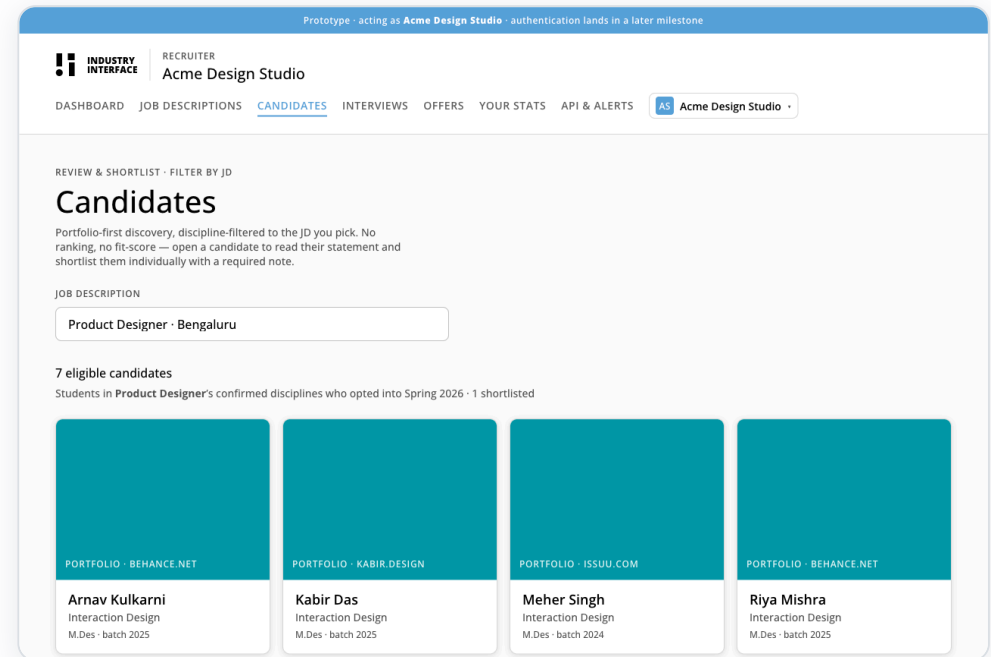
THE SOLUTION · HI-FIDELITY, BRAND-TRUE

Browse, the way a design school should.



DASHBOARD

One institution, not a separate product. Open Sans and the nid.edu blue carry the brand; the live cycle phase, rolling deadlines, and your pipelines sit one glance away.



CANDIDATES

Portfolio-first. No ranking, no fit-score. Open a student, read their statement, and shortlist one at a time with a required note. Subjective work judged subjectively, on purpose.

THE SOLUTION · HI-FIDELITY

Post a JD; run the room from your phone.

Prototype · acting as **Acme Design Studio** · authentication lands in a later milestone

INDUSTRY INTERFACE RECRUITER
Acme Design Studio

DASHBOARD JOB DESCRIPTIONS CANDIDATES INTERVIEWS OFFERS YOUR STATS API & ALERTS **AS Acme Design Studio**

SPRING 2026 · STRUCTURED JD

Post a job description

NID uses a structured JD. Fill the fields below — they make the role unambiguous for students and let the placement cell match the right disciplines. You can save a draft and finish later, or submit for moderation when ready.

Already have a JD?
Upload your existing description and we'll prefill the structured fields, then point you at the few mandatory blanks left to fill. AI only maps your text onto the form — it never scores or filters anyone.

UPLOAD YOUR JD

Role basics

ROLE TITLE *
e.g. Senior UX Designer

ROLE TYPE WORK MODE
Full-time Onsite

YOUR PROGRESS
25% 2 of 8 complete

- 1 Role basics
- 2 Compensation
- 3 **Target programmes**
- 4 Skills
- 5 Responsibilities
- 6 Deliverables
- 7 Evaluation task

JD WIZARD

Structured, with a completion meter. Upload an existing JD and ML maps it onto the fields. It only maps the text; it never scores or filters anyone.

Plan the interviews, run the rounds, then tally and send your decision — one linear flow per JD. Pick a JD to begin.

JOB DESCRIPTION

Product Designer · Bengaluru

Product Designer • PUBLISHED

Before · plan **During · rounds** After · tally

NOW RUNNING
Round 1 of 3 · Portfolio review
• IN PROGRESS

Aanya Roy Product Design

Score (0–10)

Remarks
What stood out this round

ADVANCE **HOLD** REJECT

Shortlist round 1 → advance
Candidates marked "advance" move to round 2; the rest are held out.

ADVANCE → R2

MOBILE INTERVIEW CONSOLE

The same portal as a web app on a phone. Score each round, advance or hold, and move the queue, all from the interview room.

THE SOLUTION · HI-FIDELITY

A pipeline that refuses to skip stages.

Prototype - acting as **Acme Design Studio** - authentication lands in a later milestone

INDUSTRY INTERFACE RECRUITER
Acme Design Studio

DASHBOARD JOB DESCRIPTIONS CANDIDATES **INTERVIEWS** OFFERS YOUR STATS API & ALERTS **AS** Acme Design Studio

Interviews

Plan the interviews, run the rounds, then tally and send your decision — one linear flow per JD. Pick a JD to begin.

JOB DESCRIPTION

Product Designer - Bengaluru

Product Designer **PUBLISHED**

Before - plan During - rounds After - tally

Compose the interview plan: set a per-round duration, confirm the rounds (seeded from this JD), and drag your shortlisted candidates onto the time-slot grid. Lock it when you are ready — after that the grid freezes and day-of changes become tracked overrides.

PLAN SETUP 3 rounds - seeded from this JD

Per-round duration (min)

45 **SAVE DURATION**

Rounds

- Portfolio review
- Design exercise
- Culture + leadership

INTERVIEW · BEFORE

One linear flow per JD. Plan the rounds and the per-round duration, then drag shortlisted students onto the time-slot grid. Lock it, and the plan freezes.

Prototype - acting as **Acme Design Studio** - authentication lands in a later milestone

INDUSTRY INTERFACE RECRUITER
Acme Design Studio

DASHBOARD JOB DESCRIPTIONS CANDIDATES INTERVIEWS **OFFERS** YOUR STATS API & ALERTS **AS** Acme Design Studio

Offers

WAVE-BASED, STRICT 1:1 TO POSITIONS

Pick a JD, lock the float sequence, issue offers in order, watch deadlines, and attach a certified offer letter once a student accepts. Declines and lapsed deadlines cascade to the next in sequence.

JOB DESCRIPTION

Product Designer - Bengaluru

OFFERS LOCKED

Offers unlock once interviews are marked complete

Finish recording round outcomes and confirm your selected candidates on the Interview tab. Sending the After-phase decision letter there opens the offer cascade — you'll then sequence and float offers to your selected candidates, in order.

GO TO THE INTERVIEW TAB →

NEED HELP? CONTACT YOUR PLACEMENT HEAD - INDUSTRY@NID.EDU

OFFERS · THE STAGE GATE

Offers stay locked until interviews are marked complete. The cascade is wave-based and strictly one-to-one with open positions, so a recruiter can never over-offer.

04

THE RATIONALE

Why these choices, and what they protect.

AI translates, never judges

Design is subjective. A fit-score would collapse the surface that lets a surprising portfolio win. AI disambiguates and summarises; the recruiter decides.

ML over LLM where it counts

Structured work does not need a 70B model. Extraction, matching, and stipend math run as ML and formulas, so the system stays light, fast, cheap, and self-hostable on STQC-cleared infrastructure.

Individual-only shortlist

No select-all, a required note per student. The interface makes real evaluation the path of least resistance.

Mobile-first for the interview room

The console is a web app on a phone. Day-of work happens with a device in hand, so scoring, advancing, and pinging the coordinator are built for that context first.

Brand parity with nid.edu

The recruiter should perceive one institution. Open Sans, the nid.edu blue, and the discipline palette are deliberate. Identity preservation is credibility.

A recruiter portal reverse-engineered from how NID *actually* *works.*

WHAT IT IS

Brand-true, ML-light, mobile-ready, and modular enough to migrate into the live system one surface at a time. The hidden caveats are now guardrails, and the compliance spine is built in.

THIS SUBMISSION CONTAINS

An interactive HTML showcase and this print deck. The live prototype is running:

nid-industry-interface.vercel.app/recruiter/dashboard

